

KATHA STUDIO

Temple of Ten Shadows

An archaeologist finds a relic that wakes the stone dancers of Hampi — and a smuggler who wants them silent.

Issue 04 · Adventure · Hampi

Lead: Priya Rao



Original Indian c

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Panel 1 of 6



Moon through a broken vimana. The pillars have been waiting for a listener.

NARRATOR

“Hampi does not ruin. It rehearses.”

ECHO

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Panel 2 of 6



Priya's torch finds a gold box. Ten carved dancers peel off the stone like wet ink.

PRIYA

“Easy. I am not here to steal the sentence. I am here to finish reading it.”

SHHINK

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Panel 3 of 6



A smuggler's flashlight cuts the corridor. The shadows freeze, insulted.

SMUGGLER

“Relics belong to whoever can carry them out.”

CLICK

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Panel 4 of 6



Priya does not fight him with fists. She fights him with provenance.

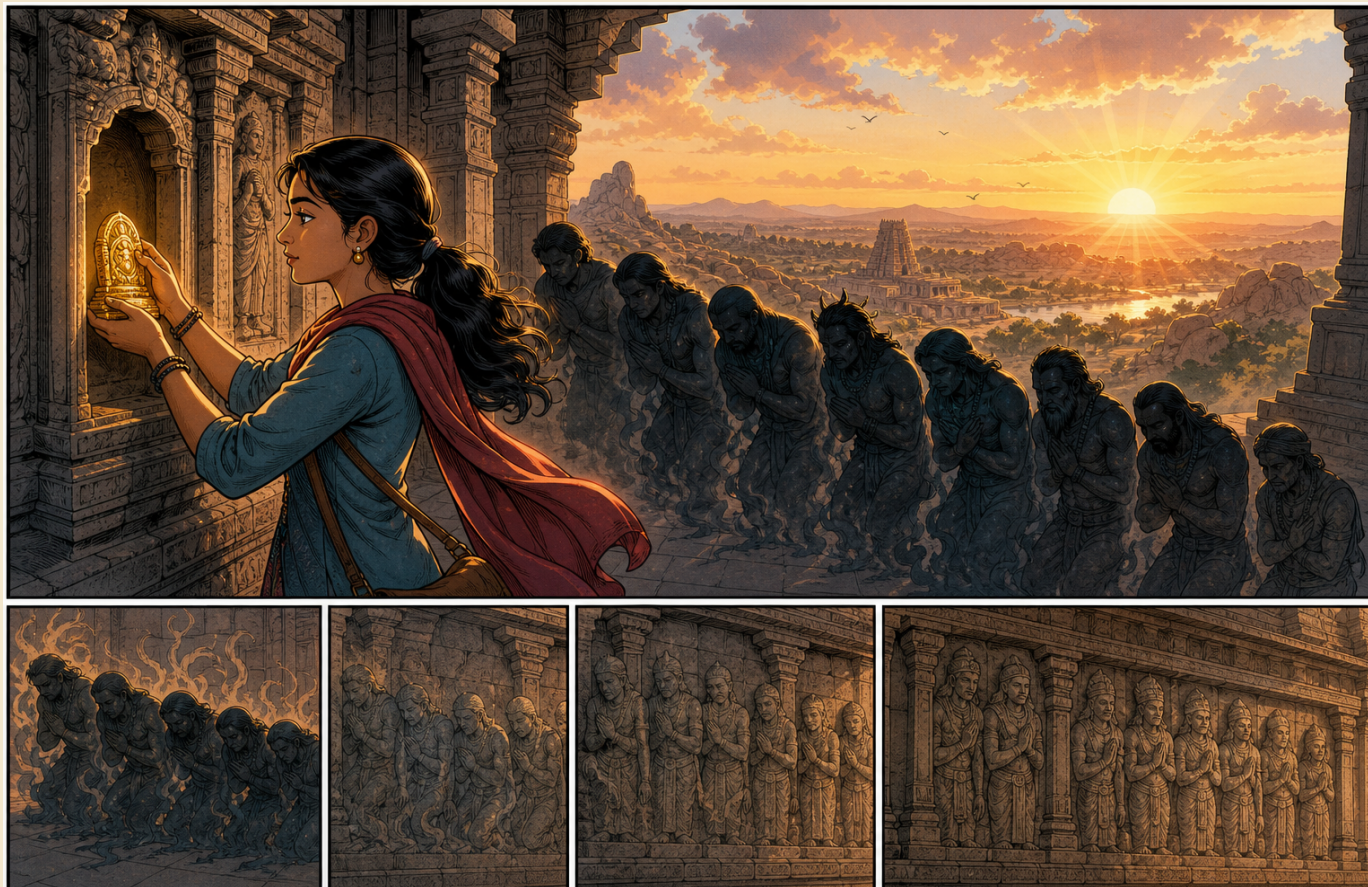
PRIYA

“Carry it out and the shadows follow you home. Ask me how I know.”

GRIND

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Panel 5 of 6



The box returns to its niche. Ten shadows bow, then become carving again.

SHADOW DANCER

“Keepers may look. Takers must dance until their feet remember stone.”

HUM

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Panel 6 of 6



Sunrise on the boulders. Priya files a report that the museum will not entirely believe.

PRIYA

“Good. Belief is optional. Respect is not.”

BIRDSONG

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